PROG 7313
[POE PART 1]

RESEARCH

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RESEARCH REPORT

1. INTRODUCTION :

Taking care of personal finances can sometimes be difficult, especially for students and adults who find it hard to take care of daily spending, monthly commitments, and budgeting goals. Although smartphone apps have made budgeting more accessible, users still find money tracking stressful, which then leads to improper use. Based on that, there is a need for a budgeting application that is not only easy to use, but also interesting to use daily.

Therefore, the purpose of this research report is to review three existing personal budgeting apps available on the Android operating system. The three applications selected will be based of their reviews, ratings and downloads as well as how they take care of the needs of users, what features they come with and how well they help with financial management. Each application will be reviewed, starting with an overview of its purpose, layout, and major functions, along with helpful screenshots with explanations. Each app's strengths and weaknesses will then be looked at based of usability, feature effectiveness, and overall user experience. The innovative features of each selected app will also be discussed.

After looking at each app, a visual comparison **(infographic)** will be done to show the similarities and differences between the three applications. Using this, a list will be made based of the best features from all 3 apps which will then be included in the proposed application. The report will finish off with a summary of all sections and a reference list of the sources used.

2. RESEARCH ON THE 3 SELECTED APPS :

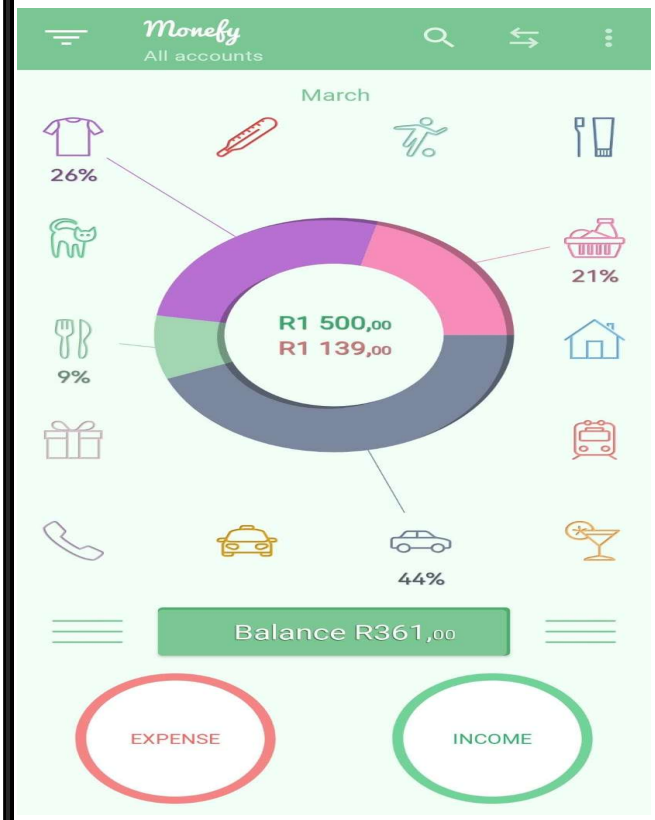
2.1 MONEFY – Budget & Expenses App

a. Overview of Monefy

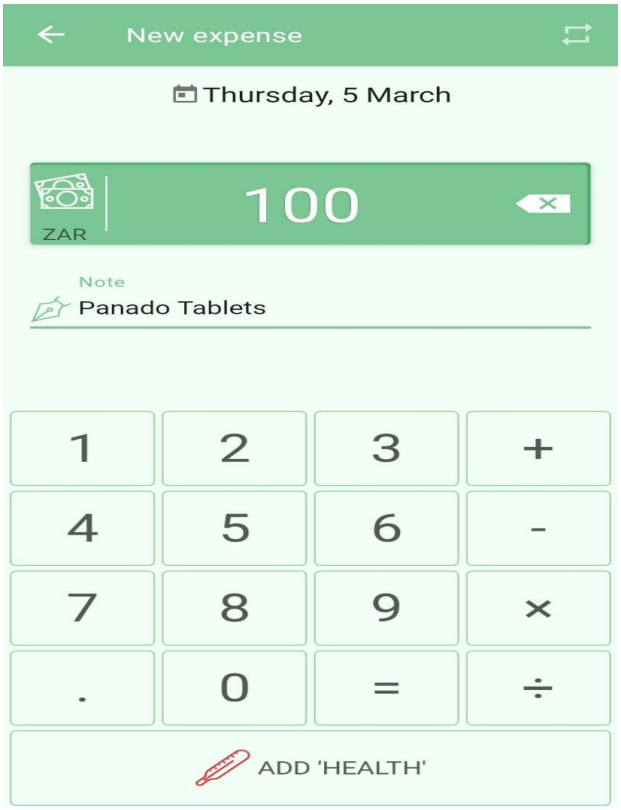
Monefy is a simple and visually attractive expense-tracking app that allows users to record their everyday spending. The dashboard shows expenses across categories in a circular chart. Users add transactions by selecting a category, entering the amount, and optionally adding a note, making logging fast and easy **(Erickson, 2022)**.

The app also gives daily and monthly spending summaries using colour-coded charts. Most key functions are useable from the main screen, keeping navigation simple. Overall, Monefy

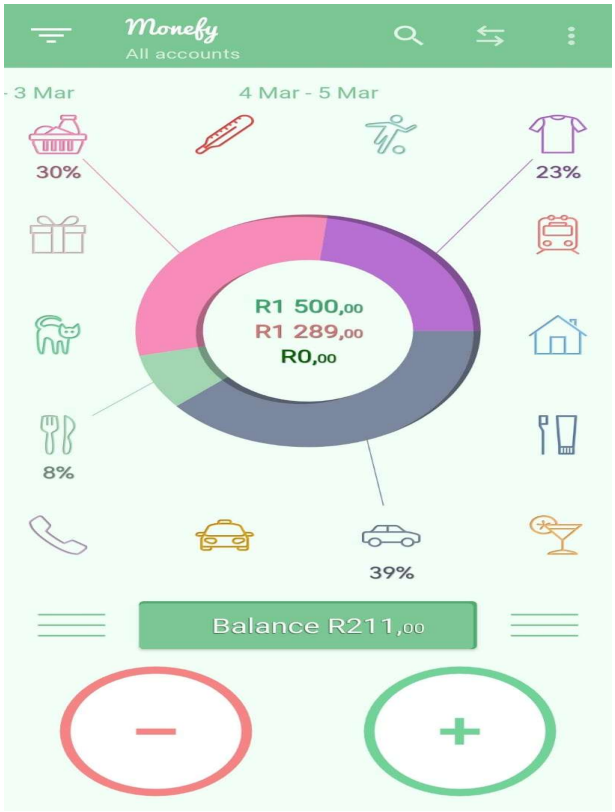
is designed for users who prefer a quick and easy way of tracking expenses rather than detailed financial planning. **(Erickson, 2022).**



The main dashboard shows a circular chart that shows how a user's expenses are divided across different categories. This makes it easy to see where most of the money is being spent. The layout is simple and helps users understand their spending. (Figure 1)



This screen lets users record a transaction by choosing a category, entering the amount and adding a note if needed. The process is quick and straightforward, which makes it easier for users to track their spending regularly. (Figure 2)



The spending summary screen shows expenses over different time periods, like daily or monthly. It uses colour-coded charts to show each category, helping users easily spot spending patterns and keep track of them budget. (Figure 3)

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b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths :

1) Streamlined User Experience

Monefy's one-tap system allows users to log expenses straight away by selecting a category and entering an amount. This is a strength because it reduces time and effort, encouraging users to regularly track spending and overall improve their budgeting habits **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

2) Immediate Visual Feedback

Spending data is shown through a colour-coded chart for users to see their patterns at a glance. This is a strength because quick visual insights help users identify overspending early, allowing for better financial decisions **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

3) Privacy-Focused Manual Tracking

Data is entered manually rather than being linked to bank accounts and can be synced through personal cloud storage. This is a strength because it gives users control over private financial data, bettering trust and security **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

4) Adaptability for Families and Travellers

Monefy supports multiple currencies and multi-device synchronisation. This is a strength because it allows users to manage shared expenses or track spending internationally, making the app more practical for diverse financial situations **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

Weaknesses :

1) Dependence on Manual Entry

Transactions must be entered consistently. This is a weakness because missed entries reduce data accuracy, which can frustrate users who want reliable financial records **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

2) Limited Customisation in the Free Version

The free version restricts category customisation. This is a weakness because it limits personalisation, making the app less effective for users who want detailed expense organising **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

3) Limited Financial Scope

Monefy lacks advanced features like investment tracking or debt management. This is a weakness because users with complex financial needs may need additional tools, decreasing the app's usefulness **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

c. Innovative Features

1) Frictionless Widget Access

Expenses can be logged straight from an Android home-screen widget. This is innovative because it integrates budgeting into daily phone use, which reduces friction and supports constant tracking **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

2) Psychological Visual Cues

Colour-coded indicators change as users reach budget limits. This is innovative because these visual prompts motivate mindful spending and behavioural design to better financial decisions **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

3) User-Controlled Cloud Synchronisation

Users can sync data through their own Google Drive or Dropbox accounts. This is innovative because it increases transparency and control over personal data, which were concerns common in other apps **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

4) Flexible Budget Cycles

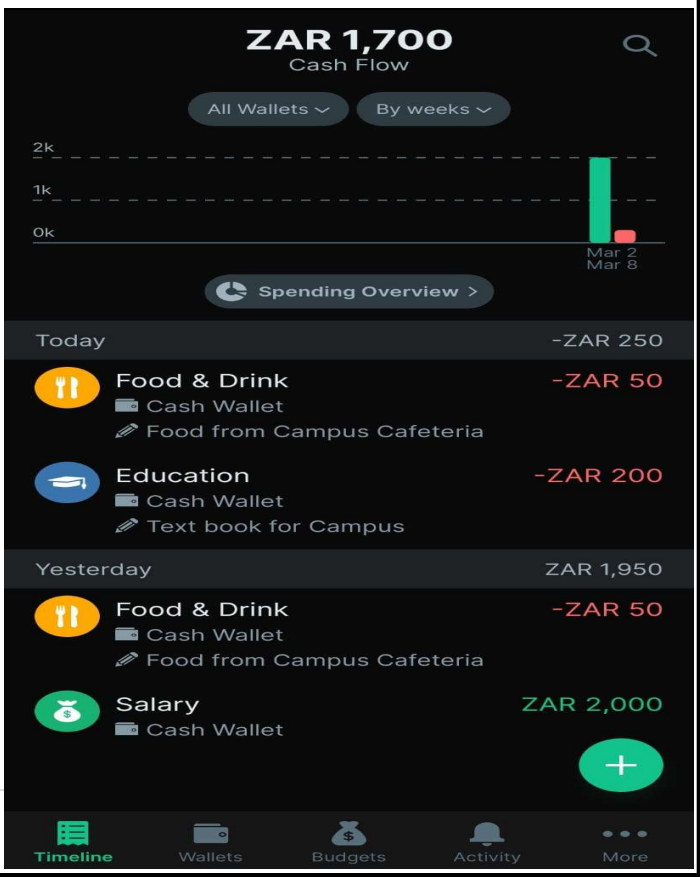
Users can set custom budget periods instead of a fixed monthly cycle. This is innovative because it lines up budgeting with different income schedules, making it more realistic for a variety of users **(Erickson, 2022; Monefy, 2026)**.

2.2SPENDEE - Daily Budget Planner

a. Overview of Spendee

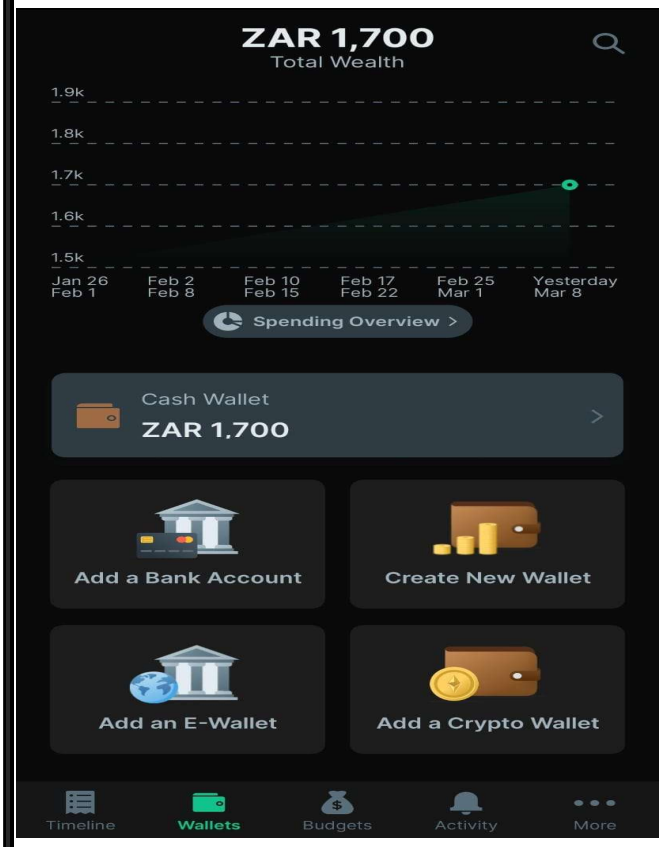
Spendee is a budgeting application that pairs expense tracking and structured financial planning. Users can set up multiple virtual wallets to handle different accounts and set overall category-specific budgets. The dashboard has a clear view of balances, recent transactions, and budget progress. Transactions are made by selecting a wallet and category, entering an amount, and giving optional details. The app also includes visual graphs and spending statistics that help users to look at financial trends over time.

(Spendee, 2026a).

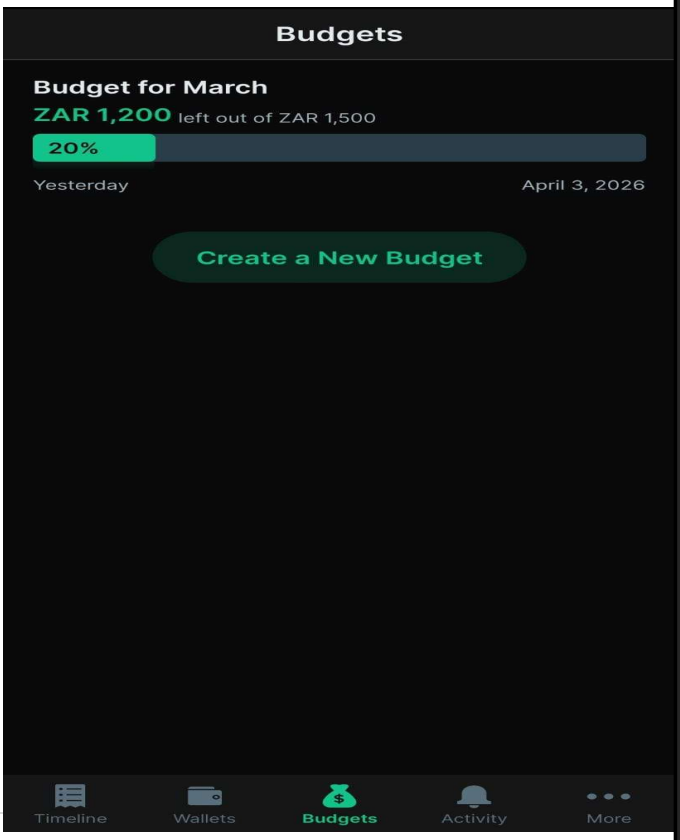


This screen shows the main dashboard in Spendee, where users can view their cash flow, recent transactions, and a visual overview of spending trends.

(Figure 4)



This screen shows the wallet management feature in Spendee, allowing users to group finances into multiple wallets that represent different accounts. (Figure 5)



This screen shows the budgeting feature in Spendee, where users can set spending limits and watch their progress throughout the budgeting period. (Figure 6)

b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths :

1) Extensive Financial Ecosystem

Spendee pairs bank accounts, e-wallets like PayPal, and cryptocurrency wallets like Coinbase, so users can see their financial situation in one place. This is a strength because it combines different financial sources, making it easier and providing users with a clear picture of their overall finances **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

2) Strong visual design

The app shows income and expenses using colourful charts and simple summaries. This is a strength since visual presentation simplifies financial data, so users can easily understand their financial situation **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

3) Collaborative Budgeting (Shared Wallets)

Spendee's Shared Wallets function lets many users control the same budget. This is a strength because it improves transparency for couples, families, or friends that split expenses **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

4) Multicurrency Support

The app supports a variety of international currencies and generates converted balance reports. This is a strength as it allows users who travel to manage international funds accurately without the need for extra conversion tools **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

Weaknesses :

1) Bank Synchronisation Issues

Although bank integration is an important feature, users can get synchronization failures or connection issues, which can cause missed transactions. This is a weakness because unreliable syncing could affect the accuracy of financial records and user trust in the app **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

2) Subscription-Based Restrictions

Many advanced features, like bank synchronization and unlimited shared wallets, need a paid subscription. This is a weakness since putting key features behind a barrier can discourage students and users from fully using the app **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

3) Limitations in Debt Handling

The app's credit card and debt management can cause inaccurate balance estimates or inflated net worth values. This is a weakness because wrong debt representations can mislead users about their true financial situation **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

c. Innovative Features

1) Auto-Categorization Engine

Spendee auto-categorises imported transactions based on a user's spending patterns. This is innovative because it lowers manual work and increases efficiency, making budgeting faster and easier for users **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

2) Proactive Daily Budgeting.

The app estimates a daily "safe-to-spend" amount depending on available cash and the time of the month. This is innovative because it encourages users to check their spending daily rather than just at the end of the month **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

3) Integrated cryptocurrency and e-wallet tracking.

Spendee tracks cryptocurrencies, e-wallets, and regular bank accounts. This is innovative because it integrates financial technology into a single platform, easing financial management for digital users **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

4) Interactive Financial Forecasting.

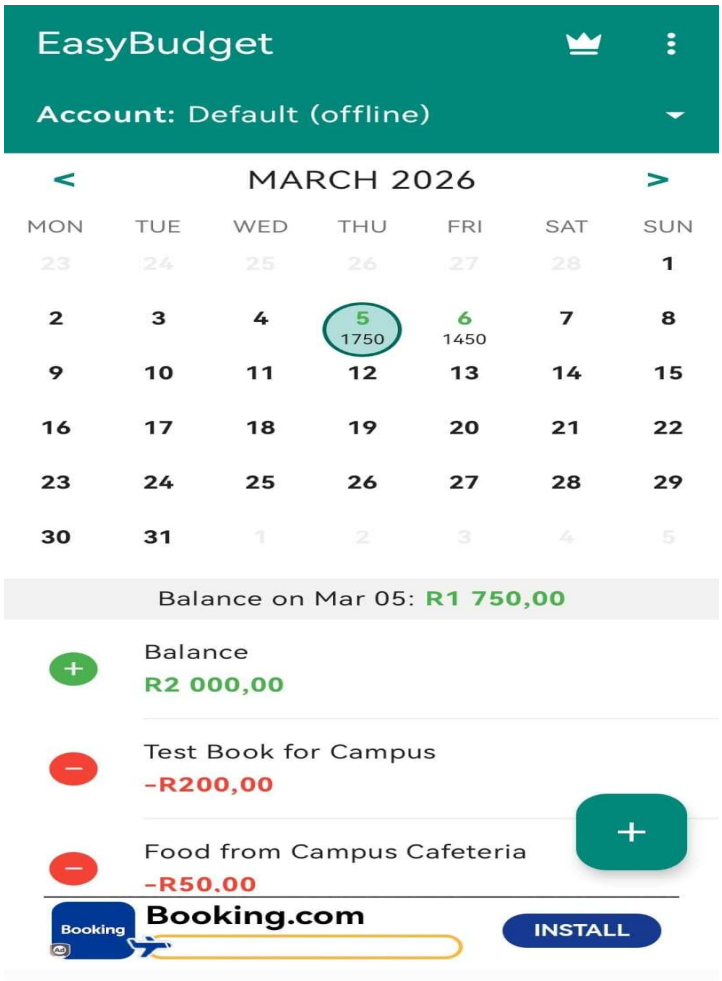
The app uses historical spending data to estimate end-of-month balances. This is innovative because it allows users to predict financial shortages and change their spending before problems appear **(Spendee, 2026a; Spendee, 2026b).**

2.3EASYBUDGET – Budget Planning

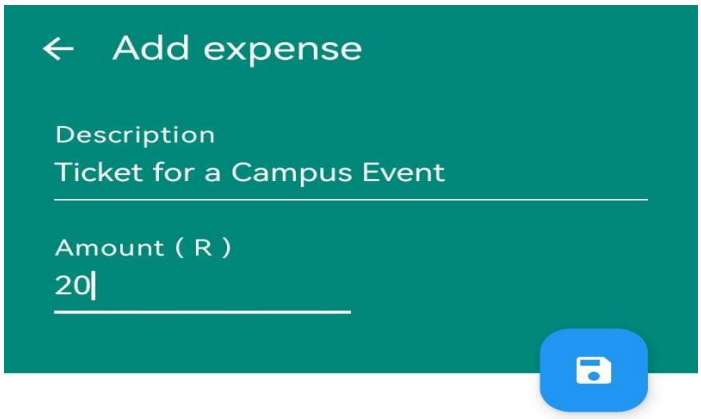
a.Overview of EasyBudget

EasyBudget is a budgeting app that focuses on structured expense tracking and easy financial overviews. The dashboard shows the total earnings, expenses, and remaining balances for a certain period, giving users a quick summary of their financial situation **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

Users can add transactions by selecting a category, entering an amount, and picking a date. Users can also create certain categories, set monthly budget objectives, and review past transactions. Unlike complex budgeting tools, EasyBudget has a straightforward UI with lists and basic charts. This style makes it perfect for people who prefer a simple and organized method to managing their funds **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**



This screenshot shows the main Dashboard of EasyBudget. Users can see their current balance and view recent transactions on a calendar, helping them track daily spending with ease. **(Figure 7)**



This screenshot shows how users can quickly log expenses in EasyBudget by entering the amount and selecting the date. This allows consistent tracking of daily spending. There is "switch" that can change the type from Expense to Income. Adding an income is the same process as logging an expense. (Figure 8)

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b. Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths :

1) Calendar-based layout

EasyBudget uses a budgeting calendar instead of a transaction list. This is a strength because it allows users to identify upcoming invoices and track cash flow throughout the month. This improves financial planning and awareness of future spending **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

2) Strong Privacy Focus

Rather than using external servers, the app keeps financial data locally on the user's device. This is a strength as it gives users more control over their financial information and lowers the chance of data privacy violations **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

3) Simple and easy to use

EasyBudget's interface is easy and simple, making entering spending quick. This is a strength since the straightforward design stops complexity and motivates users to record transactions on a regular basis without feeling stressed **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

4) Flexible Budget Periods

Users can customize their budgeting cycles to match their salary or payment dates, instead of sticking to a fixed monthly plan. This is a strength as it allows budgeting to be more lined up with actual income schedules. This improves financial accuracy and planning **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

Weaknesses :

1) Expensive Premium Version

Although the app is free to download, the premium version is expensive considering that most features still need manual tracking. This is a weakness because users can feel that the cost does not match the level of functionality given **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

2) Limited Category Controls

The app has limited controls for setting category-based spending limits. This is a weakness because it could make it harder for users to control spending in certain areas such as food, transport, or entertainment **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

3) Manual Entry Required

EasyBudget does not support bank synchronisation, meaning all transactions must be entered manually. This is a weakness because missed entries can quickly lead to incomplete or wrong financial records **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

c. Innovative Features

1) Savings Goal Tracker

The app has a savings tracker that allows users to set financial goals and monitor their progress. This is innovative because it motivates users to focus on long-term financial planning rather than only recording daily expenses **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

2) Overspending Alerts

EasyBudget analyses spending patterns and warns users when they are close to going over their budget limits. This is innovative because it gives proactive guidance that helps users adjust their spending before overspending happens **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

3) Data Export (Excel/CSV)

Users can export their financial data into spreadsheet formats like Excel or CSV for future analysis. This is innovative because it makes users look at and manage their financial data outside the app itself **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

4) Checkbook-Style Interface

The app uses a digital layout like a normal check book register. This is innovative because it combines a familiar manual budgeting method with modern touches **(Gnatyuk, 2025; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

BUDGET APP

SHOWDOWN

MONEFY VS SPENDEE VS EASYBUDGET

MONEFY – BUDGET EXPENSE TRACKER

⭐ 4.4 RATING | 📥 10M+ DOWNLOADS

WHAT IT DOES ?

FAST AND SIMPLE APP FOR TRACKING DAILY EXPENSES WITH CLEAR VISUAL CHARTS.

✓ GOOD FOR

- ONE-TAP EXPENSE LOGGING
- COLOUR-CODED SPENDING CHARTS
- MULTI-CURRENCY SUPPORT

⚠ LIMITATIONS

- TRANSACTIONS MUST BE ENTERED MANUALLY
- SOME FEATURES LOCKED IN THE FREE VERSION

💡 STANDOUT FEATURE

INSTANT VISUAL SPENDING CHARTS THAT HELP USERS SEE WHERE THEIR MONEY GOES.

SPENDEE – BUDGET PLANNER

⭐ 4.1 RATING | 📥 1 M+ DOWNLOADS

WHAT IT DOES ?

A MORE ADVANCED BUDGETING APP THAT FOCUSES ON DETAILED FINANCIAL TRACKING.

✓ GOOD FOR

- BANK AND E-WALLET INTEGRATION
- DETAILED SPENDING ANALYTICS
- SHARED WALLETS FOR GROUPS

⚠ LIMITATIONS

- PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION NEEDED FOR MANY TOOLS
- BANK SYNCING ISSUES REPORTED BY USERS

💡 STANDOUT FEATURE

AUTOMATIC TRANSACTION CATEGORISATION FOR EASIER FINANCIAL TRACKING.

EASYBUDGET – BUDGET PLANNING

⭐ 4.7 RATING | 📥 500 K+ DOWNLOADS

WHAT IT DOES ?

A SIMPLE BUDGETING TOOL DESIGNED TO HELP USERS PLAN AND MONITOR SPENDING.

✓ GOOD FOR

- CALENDAR-STYLE BUDGETING SYSTEM
- EASY-TO-USE INTERFACE
- STRONG DATA PRIVACY

⚠ LIMITATIONS

- PREMIUM VERSION CAN BE EXPENSIVE
- LIMITED SPENDING CATEGORY CONTROL

💡 STANDOUT FEATURE

SAVINGS & GOAL TRACKING TO HELP USERS STAY ON BUDGET.

4. LIST OF BEST FEATURES TO BE INCLUDED :

BEST FEATURES FROM THE 3 APPS:

- **Quick expense logging.**

An easy transaction entry system allows users to record expenses for daily tracking of spending. This is considered one of the best features since quick and easy tracking motivates users to enter their spending regularly, bettering budgeting accuracy **(Erikson, 2022; Monefy, 2026; Spendee, 2026a).**

- **Visual Spending Charts.**

Charts and graphs help users view their spending habits and find places where they could be overspending. This is seen as one of the best features because visual data makes financial information easier to understand, making users immediately find and fix bad spending habits **(Erickson, 2022; Intuit Blog Team, 2025; Spendee, 2026b).**

- **Budget Limits and Goal Tracking**

Setting budgets and savings goals helps people to manage their money more responsibly and reach their financial goals. This is taken as one of the best features as it allows for financial discipline and motivation for users towards their long-term financial goals **(Monefy, 2026; Intuit Blog Team, 2025; Spendee, 2026a).**

- **Overspending alerts.**

Notifications that tell users when they are going to go over their budget can help them stop unnecessary spending. This is regarded as one of the best features as it sends real-time warnings to users to rethink their spending before going over their budget **(Intuit Blog Team, 2025; Spendee, 2026b).**

- **Customizable spending categories.**

Allowing users to set up and edit categories helps them to manage their costs based on their financial habits. This is viewed as one of the best features because it allows the budgeting system to adjust to individual financial patterns, making expense tracking personalized. **(Erikson, 2022; Monefy, 2026; Intuit Blog Team, 2025).**

5. CONCLUSION :

In conclusion, this research report looked at three personal budgeting applications available on the Android play store. **[Monefy, Spendee, and EasyBudget]**. The purpose of this research was to understand how these apps helped users take care of their finances as well as find useful features that could be used in this **POE**. Each app was looked at based on its overview, strengths and weaknesses, and innovative features.

The research showed that each application saw budgeting in a different way. Monefy focused on simplicity and quick expense tracking with a simple interface and easy visual charts. Spendee offered more complex financial tools, like shared wallets, spending analysis, and account integration. EasyBudget went through more of a structured process by using a clean layout and calendar-style budgeting to help users organise their spending.

The infographic comparison looked at the main similarities and differences between the three apps, in terms of usability and available features. Based on that, many useful features were discovered for the proposed application, like fast expense logging, visual spending charts, and budget goal tracking. The report finally ended with a summarized conclusion and a reference list of all the sources used for this research.

6. REFERENCES :

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FINAL WORD COUNT = 2423 WORDS

(EXCLUDING MAIN HEADINGS / IN-TEXT REFERENCES / REFERENCES LIST)